Questions for each department

Ravashing Exhibitions & Events, Build side · 6 Nov 2026 · Confidential

★ = ask first if you only have ten minutes. The tag says which part of the map the answer fills. Ask about the last real stand, not how things usually go.

Project Management: Ali and other PMs

1. People ★ How many stands does one PM handle at a time, normally and at the most? Who looks after your stands when you are at another show? How many outside PMs do we hire at the busiest time, and who arranges them?

2. Flows ★ What do you receive from Design, Sales and the Coordinators (files, dates, passes)? How does each one reach you? Open one real technicals pack with me: what do you call the BOQ in it, and are colour codes (Pantones) on it? Do you check a handover pack before you release to Production: what is in it, who is the rep who gives the go-ahead, and what happens if something is missing?

3. Flows What exactly do you hand to each trade and to Logistics? How do you arrange furniture and stock with Logistics (before the site too), and how do you pass on the venue slots and passes from the Coordinators? When something changes, how do you tell them? What do you send back to the rep and the client: build schedule, site dates, questions?

4. Records ★ When you update Sales and the boss, who is the boss here, how do you send it (WhatsApp?) and who writes it down? Can you show me your Excel and one WhatsApp group for a stand? What is in each column, who else can see them, and where do the photos go?

5. Work At the Build area, how do you know how far each stand has got? How early can you tell it will be late?

6. Site On site with 10 or 20 stands: how many PMs are there, how do you note each step, and who guides the workers at a stand when you are at another one? How do you brief outside labour or outside PMs?

7. Problem ★ Is it normal for a foreman to talk to Design directly? What would stop the old-design mistake from happening again, without everything having to go through you?

8. Close How does a stand end: handover sheet, sign-off, photos, and what you tell Accounts about site changes? And what one thing do you wish you could see on your phone each morning?

Project Management: Aman, head of PMs

1. People ★ What does Production Coordination (two people between the PMs and the divisions) do, and what do they write down? What can you decide yourself, and what must go to the General Manager or the top managers?

2. Work ★ How do you give a stand to a PM? How do you see all stands and every PM's load today?

3. Capacity ★ When two stands need the same people or machines, who decides? When did you last bring in outside people for work, labour or PMs?

4. Capacity Which outside companies do you use, who keeps the list, who approves and pays, and how many outside people do you have at the busiest time?

5. Flows What do you report to the Top Managers, and how often? What do you need from each department, and when?

6. Problem How do you find out a stand is in trouble? Which shows are coming next month, and how many stands are in each?

Carpentry

1. People ★ The chart shows three senior carpenters under the foreman: who leads what, and which machine does each run? Who gives you your daily work: the PM or Production Coordination? Who does the metal work? How many outside carpenters do we use at the busiest time?

2. Work Take your last stand, from getting the technicals to the mock-up. How did you decide Paint and Electric could start, and who said the mock-up was good?

3. Flows ★ Who gives you the technicals? Last time you had a doubt about a drawing, who did you ask, and did you tell the PM?

4. Flows Which other departments do you talk to (Paint, Spray Paint, Electric, Branding, Logistics) and about what? Phone, WhatsApp, paper or in person?

5. Records ★ What do you write down: progress, materials, who worked, hours? Today the PMs keep your information. What do you tell the PM about progress, and how (phone, WhatsApp)? What would you need if you kept a simple list yourself? Can you show me anything you write down?

6. Capacity How many stands at once is too many? Who decides which goes first, and when do you use outside carpenters? What do your people do on site, and who guides outside workers there?

7. Problem ★ What went wrong most recently, and who noticed first? What one thing do you wish you could see quickly?

Water Paint

1. People ★ Who heads Water Paint, and is there a manager above him? How many people are in the team (ours and outside, normally and at the busiest)? Who keeps the labour information?

2. Work Take your last stand, from the first parts arriving to finished. What do you paint (water paint and primer), and how is it different from spray paint? What is done here, and what is left for site?

3. Flows ★ How do you know a part is ready for you, and where do the colours come from? If the colour changes, how do you hear? Which departments do you talk to, and how?

4. Records ★ What do you write down: paint used, colours, who worked, hours? Who keeps these records, and where? Can you show me?

5. Capacity How many stands at once? Who decides which goes first, and when do you use outside painters? Who paints on site, and who briefs them on colours? How do you work with Spray Paint?

6. Problem ★ What went wrong most recently, and who noticed first? What one thing do you wish you could see quickly?

Electric

1. People ★ Who gives you your daily work: the PM or Production Coordination? Who are the outside AV and lighting people, who books them, and how many do we use at the busiest time? When the six electricians are all busy, who does the extra work?

2. Work What do you fit at the Build area, and what is left for site? Who makes the plan for sockets and lights, and how do you test your work?

3. Flows ★ How do you know a stand is ready for you? If the electrical plan changes, how do you hear? Which departments do you talk to, and how?

4. Records ★ On site, does anyone besides the PM note your progress? Which lights, cables and AV items do we own, reuse or hire, and who tracks where they are? How do you ask Procurement for material?

5. Capacity How many stands at once? Who decides which goes first, and when do you use outside electricians? Who connects to the venue power and tests before opening?

6. Problem ★ What went wrong most recently, and who noticed first? What one thing do you wish you could see quickly?

Spray Paint

1. People ★ Who is the foreman, and is there a manager above him? How many people are in the team (ours and outside, normally and at the busiest)? Why is spray paint a separate department from Paint?

2. Work Take your last stand: when do parts reach you, where do you spray, and how long do they dry? Is the spray area or drying time ever a limit? What makes you spray on site in the rare cases, and who decides?

3. Flows ★ How do you know a part is ready for you, and who gives you the colours? If a colour changes, how do you hear? How do you work with Paint and Carpentry, and who do you tell when you finish?

4. Records ★ What do you write down: paint used, colours, who worked, hours? Who keeps these records, and where? Can you show me?

5. Capacity How many stands at once? Who decides which goes first, and when do you use outside spray painters?

6. Problem ★ What went wrong most recently, and who noticed first? What one thing do you wish you could see quickly?

Branding (Graphics, CNC, Logo)

1. People ★ On the HR chart this department is called Printing, Acrylic and CNC, with no Branding box. Is Branding the same department? Where does Logo fit: is it the acrylic work? How many outside people do we use at the busiest time?

2. Work Take your last stand, from the zip file you get from Design to graphics on the stand. What is in the zip? What do you print yourselves and what goes outside? What are the graphic and logo mock-ups, and who approves them?

3. Flows ★ Who gives you the technicals and the logo? Has the client already approved the sizes and the print proof before you start? Who do you ask about measurements? How do you hear a design changed, and has anything been printed twice?

4. Flows How do you tell the PM your progress, and how do you agree sizes with Carpentry? Which other departments do you talk to, and how?

5. Records ★ Where are the final print files kept, who keeps them, and how do you know which version was printed? What else do you write down?

6. Parts What does each part do: Graphics, CNC, Logo? What does CNC cut, and for whom (Carpentry too)? How does a finished logo reach the stand?

7. Site Who fits the graphics on site? What happens if one does not fit? How many stands at once, and when do you use outside people?

8. Problem ★ What went wrong most recently, and who noticed first? What one thing do you wish you could see quickly?

Logistics

1. People ★ The chart shows Transport as 7 people. Does Transport do only trucks and loading, or also site work? Who plans the trucks and keeps the bookings? Are the vehicles ours or hired, and who do you take work from: the PM or Production Coordination?

2. Work Take the last stand you sent. How did you know it was ready, who made the load list, and who checked it at the site?

3. Flows ★ Do you get venue slots and passes from the PM or from the Coordinators? How do the PM and you arrange furniture and stock to load? How does the PM learn the truck has left, reached and offloaded? Which other departments do you talk to?

4. Records ★ What do you write down: bookings, load lists, costs for each stand? Who writes it, and where? Is there one place where all coming site dates can be seen?

5. After Does your work stop at delivery, or do you help build? Who is in charge at site? After the show, what comes back, who checks it, and who removes the scrap and at what cost?

6. Overseas For jobs outside the UAE, how does the stand get there? Who handles shipping and customs, and who travels?

7. Problem ★ How many stands do you move in the same week, and who decides which goes first? What went wrong most recently?